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With this basic idea of how Excel treats date and time functions we can go on to doing date and time calculations. The most com-

|   | A         | B         | C         |
|---|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| 1 | 14-Apr-07 | 22-May-00 | 2518      |
| 2 | 14-Apr-07 | 25        | 20-Mar-07 |

Simple date calculations

mon calculation you'll use dates for is to find out the elapsed days or times between two dates. For example, if you want to find out the number of days between 14th April 2007 and 22nd May 2000, do the following:

Enter the above dates into two cells, say A1 and B1 respectively. Now you can simply type in, say, cell C1 `"= A1-B1"`. The result, however, may be shown in the date format, since Excel "sees" dates in both the cells and assumes that the format for the result should also be in date format. To change it to the number format, right click on cell C1, select Format cells, and choose the Number option on the Number tab. This will then show the number of days between the two dates. Likewise if you want to find out, say, the date 25 days prior to 14th April, you can use a formula as in the figure below. In this case, the result will directly show you the date.

### 9.3.1. Date Functions

#### TODAY()

Of all the date functions, the easiest has to be the TODAY function. Entered as `"=TODAY()"`, it has no arguments, and returns the current date in the cell. Note that the date in the cell will keep changing every time the workbook is opened on different dates. This function should not be used if you want the date to remain fixed